

Name: _____

Date: _____

Australian Curriculum v9.0 Aligned | AC9E6LY04 | Year 6 | Complex Texts, Perspective & Sustained Argument

LEARNING INTENTION

I am learning to analyse complex texts by examining perspective, evaluating evidence and constructing sustained, well-reasoned arguments.

READING STRATEGY

Identify the author's perspective and purpose. Evaluate the quality of evidence. Consider whose voice is missing. Challenge assumptions and construct your own reasoned position.

READ THE PASSAGE — READ IT 3 TIMES!

As natural coral reefs around the world **deteriorate** due to climate change and human activity, scientists are engineering **artificial reefs** to compensate.

These **structures** — made from steel, concrete, recycled materials or even 3D-printed ceramics — provide **substrate** on which coral can grow.

Japan has deployed over 20,000 artificial reefs across its waters, dramatically increasing fish populations and supporting local **fisheries**.

In the **Maldives**, artificial reefs are providing income through diving tourism as natural reefs bleach.

However, the science is not **straightforward**. Poorly designed artificial reefs can introduce **invasive species**, damage seagrass beds and create **dependency** rather than ecological recovery. Critics question whether artificial reefs are genuine **ecological restoration** or merely an **elaborate** form of environmental avoidance.

The most successful projects combine artificial structures with active coral **transplantation**, water quality management and community **involvement**.

Ultimately, artificial reefs are a **supplement** — not a substitute — for addressing the underlying causes of reef destruction.

VOCABULARY HELPER

- deteriorate = become progressively worse
- substrate = a surface on which organisms grow
- invasive species = species that spread aggressively in a new environment
- ecological restoration = returning a damaged ecosystem to its natural state
- transplantation = moving living organisms to a new location to help them grow

WARM UP — BEFORE YOU READ

Is it better to fix environmental problems at their source or manage their consequences? Write 2 sentences:

A — COMPREHENSION

1. What materials are artificial reefs made from?

2. What positive results has Japan seen from artificial reefs?

3. Name 2 potential problems with poorly designed artificial reefs:

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Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Warm Up: Accept personal view about source vs consequence.

A1. Steel, concrete, recycled materials, 3D-printed ceramics. **A2.** Dramatically increased fish populations and supported fisheries. **A3.** Introducing invasive species, damaging seagrass beds, creating ecological dependency — any 2. **A4.** They are a supplement, not a substitute for fixing underlying causes.

B1. Supplement = adds to something existing; substitute = replaces it. This distinction is critical — artificial reefs cannot replace real reefs, only support them. **B2.** Environmental avoidance = focusing on consequences rather than causes (climate change). Accept personal reasoned view.

C: The em-dash creates a pause that emphasises the contrast 'not a substitute' — it is more emphatic than a comma. 'Not straightforward' = academic hedging; signals to the reader that complexity follows and they should not expect a simple answer.

High Five! You are a Super Reader! ✓

Colour a star each time you read the passage aloud:

★ ★ ★ ★ ★

EXTENSION ACTIVITY

Design a proposal for an artificial reef project in a location of your choice. Include: location rationale, materials, expected outcomes, potential risks and how success will be measured.

PARENT TIP

Watch a documentary about coral reef restoration. Ask: 'What is more important — fixing the cause or managing the damage? Can we do both?'

TEACHER TIP

Connect to Science and Geography. Students research a real artificial reef project and evaluate its success. Debate: 'Artificial reefs are a distraction from real environmental action.'

STUDENT REFLECTION

- ☐ I can explain the difference between a supplement and a substitute in an argument
- ☐ I can identify and explain the effect of specific punctuation choices
- ☐ I can write a sustained argument incorporating scientific evidence